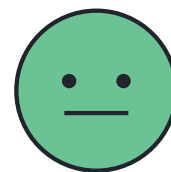
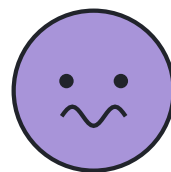
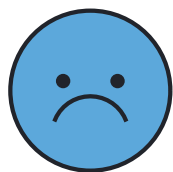


TEEN WELLBEING SEL SERIES



Regulate

A Teen's Guide to Understanding and Managing Big Emotions

Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

Ages 10-19 - Printable

Home - Classroom - Counseling - Calm Corners

Reproducible for one home or classroom



How to Use This Book

This workbook is made for ages 10 to 19 - a stage packed with change, pressure, and big emotions. It won't talk down to you. Instead, it gives you real tools, honest questions, and space to think for yourself.

There are no grades and no wrong answers. Work at your own pace, be honest in the writing spaces, and come back to the pages that help most. Skills grow with practice.

For Grown-Ups

- ☐ Give privacy - journaling is more honest when it isn't graded or read without permission.
- ☐ Offer to talk, but don't force it; being available matters more than pushing.
- ☐ Model the skills yourself - teens notice what adults actually do.
- ☐ If big feelings feel unmanageable, connect the teen with a counselor or trusted professional.

Tip: There are no wrong answers here. Every feeling is okay. What matters is what we choose to DO with big feelings.



How This Book Works

Each part mixes three things: short explanations of what's going on in your brain and body, self-checks to notice your own patterns, and tools plus reflection to help you respond in ways you feel good about.

Getting the most from it

- ☐ Be honest - this is for you, not for show.
- ☐ Try the tools more than once before deciding if they help.
- ☐ Use the trackers to spot patterns over a week or two.
- ☐ Revisit the plans and update them as you learn.

This activity book supports everyday social-emotional learning and self-reflection. It is not therapy or medical advice. If you are struggling with your safety or mental health, please talk to a trusted adult, a counselor, or a local helpline right away.

What's Inside



- 1 Understanding Emotions
- 2 Knowing My Patterns
- 3 My Coping Toolkit
- 4 Rewiring My Thinking
- 5 Real-Life Scenarios
- 6 Reflection & Plan



Part 1: Understanding Emotions

Emotions aren't the enemy - they're information.



What Emotions Actually Do

Emotions are signals from your brain and body. Fear says 'watch out,' anger says 'something feels unfair,' sadness says 'something matters and it hurt.' None of them are 'bad' - they're data. The skill isn't turning emotions off; it's learning to read them and choose your response.

During the teen years your brain is literally rewiring. The emotional part develops faster than the part that hits the brakes - which is exactly why big feelings can feel so intense and sudden. That's normal, and it's also why practicing these skills now makes a real difference.

Three quick truths

- ☐ A feeling is not a fact or a command.
- ☐ Feelings pass - even the big ones peak and fade.
- ☐ You can feel something strongly and still choose what you do.

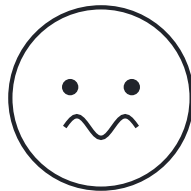
Naming It Precisely



Color each face. Say the feeling out loud!



Frustrated



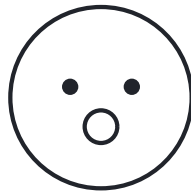
Anxious



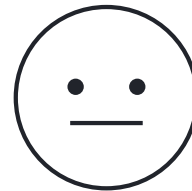
Disappointed



Content



Overwhelmed



Settled

The Feeling Wave



Emotions tend to rise, peak, and fall like a wave - usually within about 90 seconds for the first surge, if we don't keep feeding it with our thoughts. If you can ride the first wave without acting on it, you often make far better choices.

'Riding the wave' doesn't mean ignoring the feeling. It means noticing it, breathing through the peak, and letting it settle before you decide what to do.

Riding the wave

- ☐ Notice: 'A wave is starting.'
- ☐ Breathe slowly through the peak.
- ☐ Wait for it to settle before you act or speak.



Part 2: Knowing My Patterns

Self-awareness is the first tool.



My Emotion Habits

Rate how true each is for you right now. Notice - don't judge.

1 = Never 5 = Always

I can name what I'm feeling when it happens.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I notice feelings in my body before they get huge.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I pause before reacting when I'm upset.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I bounce back after a bad mood in a reasonable time.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I ask for help when a feeling is too big.

(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

I'm kind to myself when I mess up.

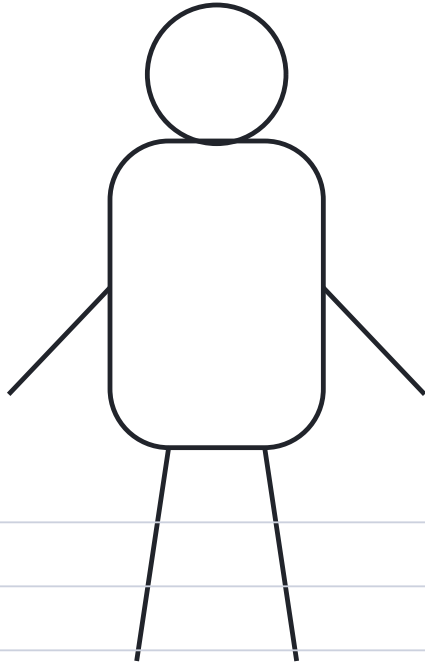
(1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

What my answers tell me



Where Do I Feel It?

Big feelings live in our bodies too. Anger might feel hot in your chest. Worry might feel like butterflies in your tummy. Color or mark where you feel your feelings.



Draw or color:

-  Hot / angry feelings
-  Fluttery / worried feelings
-  Heavy / sad feelings
-  Calm / good feelings

Today my body feels...

Weekly Mood & Energy Tracker



Tracking your mood helps you spot patterns - what lifts you up and what drains you. Each day, shade your mood level (1 low - 5 high) and note one thing that affected it.

	1	2	3	4	5	What affected it?
Mon						
Tue						
Wed						
Thu						
Fri						
Sat						
Sun						



Part 3: My Coping Toolkit

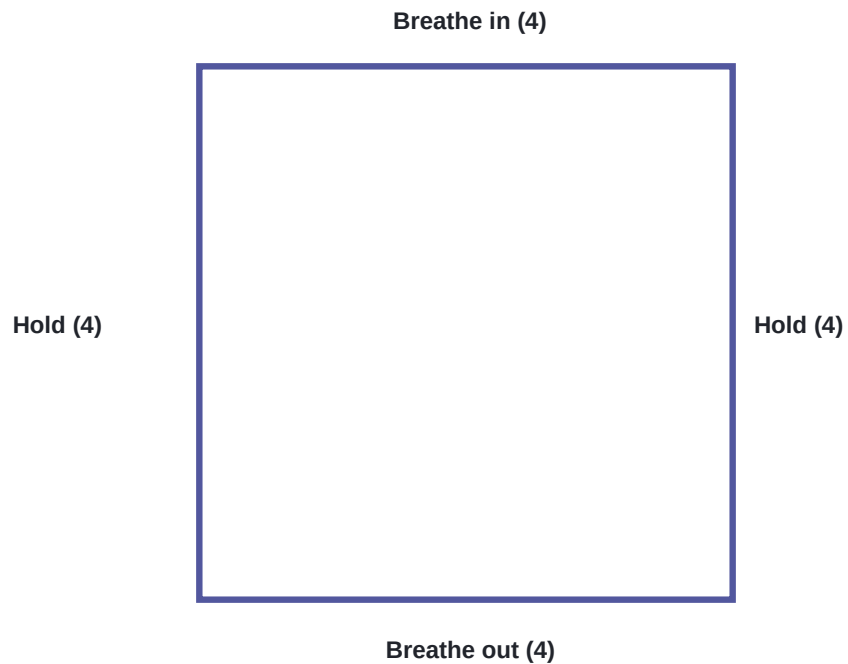
Tools you can actually use in the moment.



Box Breathing

Slow breathing tells our body it is safe. Trace the shape slowly with your finger while you breathe. Do it 3-5 times.

Box Breathing



1. Breathe in for 4 as you trace up.
2. Hold for 4 across the top.
3. Breathe out for 4 down the side.
4. Hold for 4 across the bottom.
5. Repeat until the wave settles.

My Coping Menu



There's no single 'right' tool. Tick the ones you want to try, and star the ones that work.

Fast resets (under 2 minutes)

- ☐ Slow breathing: in for 4, out for 6, a few rounds.
- ☐ Cold water on your face or hands.
- ☐ Name 5 things you see, 4 you hear, 3 you can touch.
- ☐ Unclench your jaw, drop your shoulders, shake out your hands.

Move & release

- ☐ Walk, stretch, or do a few push-ups or jumping jacks.
- ☐ Put on a song and move to it.
- ☐ Squeeze and release your muscles from head to toe.

Connect & express

- ☐ Text or talk to someone you trust.
- ☐ Write or draw what you're feeling - no filter.
- ☐ Do something kind for someone else.

Longer-term care

- ☐ Keep a steady sleep routine.
- ☐ Limit doom-scrolling before bed.
- ☐ Spend time on something that gives you meaning.

Stress & Trigger Log



When you feel stressed or overwhelmed, logging it helps you understand your triggers and what actually helps. Fill one row when a stressful moment happens.

- 1** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 2** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 3** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____
- 4** Situation / trigger: _____
Body & feelings (0-10): _____
What I did: _____
Did it help?: _____



Part 4: Rewiring My Thinking

Change the thought, change the feeling.



Common Thinking Traps

Everyone's brain falls into 'thinking traps' sometimes. Naming them helps you step back. Circle the ones you notice most, then write an example.

All-or-nothing

Seeing things as total success or total failure, no middle ground.

Catastrophizing

Assuming the worst possible outcome will happen.

Mind-reading

Believing you know others are judging you - without proof.

Labeling

Calling yourself 'stupid' or 'a failure' over one event.

A thinking trap I fall into, and a real example:

Filtering

Only noticing the negatives and ignoring the positives.

Should statements

Harsh rules like 'I should always...' that set you up to feel bad.



Catch It, Check It, Change It

Our thoughts shape our feelings. Sometimes an automatic thought is unhelpful or untrue. You can CATCH the thought, CHECK if it's fair and true, and CHANGE it into a more balanced one. This is a skill - it gets easier with practice.

1. The situation (just the facts):

2. The automatic thought that popped up:

3. The feeling it gave me (and how strong, 0-10):

4. Check it: Is it 100% true? What's the evidence? Am I mind-reading or catastrophizing?

5. A more balanced, fair thought:

6. How I feel now:



Part 5: Real-Life Scenarios

Practice choosing your response.



What Would You Do? (1)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

- 1** You get a bad grade and feel like giving up on the whole subject.

What could you do?

- 2** A friend leaves you on read and your mind races to the worst.

What could you do?

- 3** You snap at a family member and feel guilty afterward.

What could you do?



What Would You Do? (2)

Read each situation. There are many good choices! Think it through, then write or draw what you could do to stay calm and kind.

1 You feel jealous seeing others' posts and your mood drops.

What could you do?

2 You're overwhelmed by everything due this week.

What could you do?

3 Someone criticizes you in front of others.

What could you do?

My Personal Wellbeing Plan



Pull it all together. This is your go-to plan when things get hard.

My early warning signs that a feeling is getting big:

My top 3 tools that actually work for me:

People I can reach out to (and how):

Kind, true things I can tell myself:

One habit that helps me feel steady:



When You Need More Help

Some feelings are too big to handle alone - and that's not weakness, it's human. Reaching out is a strong, smart move.

Reach out if...

- ☐ A feeling won't ease up for days, or keeps getting worse.
- ☐ You're avoiding things you used to enjoy.
- ☐ You have thoughts of hurting yourself or others.
- ☐ You just need someone to talk to - that's reason enough.

Who I can reach out to

If you ever feel unsafe or think about hurting yourself, tell a trusted adult now or contact a local emergency number or crisis/helpline in your country right away. You deserve support.



What Matters to Me

Knowing what matters to you makes decisions and hard days easier. When you act in line with your values, stress often makes more sense and feels more manageable.

Three values that matter most to me

One goal that fits those values

One small step I can take this week

Checking In With Myself



What's one thing I'm handling better than I used to?

What still feels hard, and what might help?



Saying It: Boundary Scripts

A boundary is a limit that protects your wellbeing. Boundaries can be kind AND firm. Practice wording so it's ready when you need it.

Saying no without over-explaining: "No thanks, that doesn't work for me." My version:

Asking for space: "I need some time to myself right now." My version:

Naming a limit online: "Please don't share that." My version:

Asking for what I need: "It would help me if..." My version:



A Letter to Future Me

Write a short letter to yourself six months from now.

What do you hope is different? What do you want to remember?



Good Things Worth Noticing

Noticing good things helps calm our minds and lift our mood. It doesn't erase hard feelings, but it reminds us that good things are here too.

Three good things about today

Someone I'm thankful for - and why

Draw something that makes you smile:

My Notes & Reflections



Lined area for notes and reflections, consisting of 20 horizontal lines.



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A large, empty rectangular box with rounded corners and a thin grey border, intended for a drawing.

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